

SAM.gov Registration

Complete Checklist

Everything you need to gather, complete, and maintain your System for Award Management registration — the mandatory first step to receiving federal contracts.

1**BEFORE YOU
START**

Gather Your Business Identity Information

- **Legal business name**

Exactly as filed with your state — must match IRS records

- **Business structure**

LLC, Corporation, Sole Proprietor, Partnership, etc.

- **Physical business address**

P.O. Boxes are not accepted as primary address

- **Business start date**

The date your entity was legally formed

- **Business phone number**

A working number for your entity

■ *Tip: All information in SAM.gov must match your IRS records exactly or registration will be rejected.*

2**IRS REQUIRED**

Obtain Your EIN (Employer Identification Number)

- **Apply for EIN at [irs.gov](https://www.irs.gov)**

Free — takes minutes online; instant issuance for most entities

- **EIN confirmation letter (CP 575)**

Save this — you will need it to verify your EIN in SAM.gov

- **Confirm EIN matches your legal business name**

IRS name/EIN mismatch is the #1 cause of SAM.gov rejection

■ *Note: Sole proprietors may use their SSN as EIN, but obtaining a separate EIN is strongly recommended.*

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SAM.gov STEP 1

Get Your Unique Entity Identifier (UEI)**Go to SAM.gov and click 'Register Your Entity'**

Always use SAM.gov directly — third-party sites charge fees

Create a Login.gov account if you don't have one

Login.gov is the secure federal identity system required for SAM

Request your UEI during registration

UEI is assigned automatically when you begin entity registration

Save your UEI number

You will need this on all proposals, invoices, and federal forms

■ **Important:** The UEI replaced the DUNS number in April 2022. Do not use DUNS for new registrations.

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CLASSIFICATION

Identify Your NAICS Codes**Primary NAICS code**

The code that best describes your main business activity

Additional NAICS codes

Add all codes that apply — you can list multiple

Verify size standards for each NAICS code

SBA size standards determine small business eligibility per code

Note your PSC / FSC codes if applicable

Product Service Codes used for supplies and equipment contracts

■ **Resource:** Search NAICS codes at census.gov/naics — pick codes that match how agencies will search for you.

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PAYMENT SETUP

Prepare Your Financial & Banking Information**Bank name and address**

The bank where you want federal payments deposited

Account type

Checking or savings — checking is standard for business

Routing number (ABA)

9-digit number — confirm directly with your bank

Account number

Your business checking account number

Lockbox number (if applicable)

Only required for certain federal payment arrangements

■ **Required:** Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT) banking info is mandatory — the government pays electronically.

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SAM.gov STEP 2

Complete Your Core Data / Entity Information

- **Legal business name & DBA (if applicable)**
Enter DBA only if your business operates under a trade name
- **Physical and mailing address**
Both are required; they may be the same
- **Congressional district**
SAM.gov auto-populates based on your address
- **Business types**
Select all that apply: small business, minority-owned, veteran-owned, etc.
- **Organization structure**
Corporation, LLC, sole proprietor, partnership, etc.
- **Fiscal year end date**
Month and day your fiscal year ends

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SAM.gov STEP 3

Complete Assertions & Representations

- **FAR 52.212-3 — Offeror Representations & Certifications**
Required for commercial item acquisitions
 - **FAR 52.219-1 — Small Business Program Representations**
Self-certify your small business status per NAICS
 - **DFARS representations (if pursuing DoD contracts)**
Additional certifications required for defense work
 - **Disaster response registry (optional)**
Opt in if you want to be considered for disaster relief contracts
 - **EDI information (if applicable)**
Electronic Data Interchange — most small businesses leave blank
- *Note: You are certifying under penalty of law — review each representation carefully before submitting.*

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SAM.gov STEP 4

Submit & Activate Your Registration

- **Review all entries for accuracy**
Errors are the leading cause of delayed or rejected registrations
 - **Submit registration**
SAM.gov will send a confirmation email with a tracking number
 - **Allow 1–3 business days for activation**
Federal processing time — you cannot bid until status shows 'Active'
 - **Save your SAM.gov login credentials securely**
You will need these to renew and update your registration
 - **Confirm 'Active' status before submitting any proposal**
Check your entity status at SAM.gov before each bid
- *Warning: Never pay a third party to register or renew — SAM.gov registration is always free.*

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ONGOING

Annual Renewal & Maintenance

- **Set a calendar reminder 60 days before expiration**

Registration expires exactly 1 year from activation date

- **Renew before expiration — do not let it lapse**

A lapsed registration disqualifies you from receiving awards

- **Update any changed information promptly**

Address, banking, or ownership changes must be updated within 30 days

- **Re-certify representations annually**

All FAR/DFARS reps must be re-certified at each renewal

- **Verify your NAICS codes are still accurate**

Update codes if your business has expanded into new areas

■ **Critical:** Agencies cannot award contracts to vendors with lapsed SAM.gov registrations — renewals are non-negotiable.

Free Registration Help:

SAM.gov registration is always **100% free**. Never pay a third party. If you need assistance, contact your local **Procurement Technical Assistance Center (PTAC)** at aptac.org or your **SBA district office** — both offer free one-on-one guidance. For technical issues with SAM.gov, call the Federal Service Desk at **866-606-8220**.